

Story

The film opens with some kind of shot that presents the house in a wide angle with the protagonist bringing moving boxes into the house, the shot slowly crosses the front lawn as more boxes are being brought in before reaching the front door, the door gets a double knock from the postman, the protagonist answers and thanks the postman before going back inside, the camera follows the protagonist inside, we get a brief flash of the title card.

The camera continues to travel throughout the house showing a time lapse of unpacking and furnishing, perhaps even zooming into a calendar and then zooming back out. It zooms back out to show the protagonist going to unpack the final boxes, they lift one knocking over a lamp which falls into a wall creating a knock sound, the protagonist lifts the lamp back then goes to walk off with a box, however they hear a knock back and turn to look at the wall, they approach the wall after placing down the box and examine it for a second, they then decide to jokingly knock back, a few seconds pass and they hear one back, they giggle to themselves and decide to knock back, hearing nothing back and after a few seconds they continue on, what follows is another brief unpacking montage which ends at late evening time with the protagonist sitting watching a horror movie in bed. The knocking starts up again and the protagonist is looking visibly annoyed this time around, the protagonist waits for a minute before calling out for the neighbour to shut up, there's an eerie silence after that, the protagonist switches off the TV, and goes to bed.

The screen is black, but faint knocks start to be heard, growing in volume and clarity, the camera slowly transitions out of darkness and into focus showing the knocks slowly wake the protagonist, they jolt awake to a slight panic, asking themselves quietly "what the fuck" before shouting "what is your problem." As soon as they do they hear quick footsteps disappearing on the other side of the wall, there's silence, and the protagonist is standing waiting to see if the neighbour has quit, they sigh and decide to go back to bed before casually glancing at the window only to get a shock from a dark figure peering inside and then runs off, there's a bolt of tense music and the protagonist is visibly scared and panicked. They frantically search for a (Sports) stick and pluck up the courage to go take a look outside, they slowly creep up the hallway and open the front door, they pluck up some more courage and quickly but quietly burst out the front to confront the creature, they look around and the camera shows the empty and desolate neighbourhood, there isn't a sound, until fast footsteps are heard scuttling around the side of the neighbour's house causing the protagonist to jump and snap back to defensive mode. They cross along the front of the neighbour's house to peer round the side of the house, nothing is there, cut to them crossing back along but the neighbour's front door is open, this gives the protagonist a jump as they turn and glance into the darkness, they gather the courage to enter, they ready their stick in preparation to fight any threats, as they creep down the hallway they notice how dilapidated the place is, they enter the room that mirrors their own room only to see a beaten and blackened wall where the knocks are coming from, this is the other side of the wall they've been knocking. As they go to examine it, the figure can be seen standing in the doorway, the protagonist looks at the wall but quickly looks to the side when they hear a creak at the door, they stare at the door for a few seconds before looking back towards the wall, when they do a huge melds its way through the wall creating a jump scared and knocking the protagonist back, they fall and when they hit the ground they wake up in bed, realising it was all a dream... but the knocks heard at the start of the dream are still there, they quickly stand up, look around and visibly realise this is how the dream started, they say to themselves "Oh fuck off" look around, grab their headphones play some music and head back to sleep.

It then cuts to shots of the neighbourhood in broad daylight, and then to the protag's phone alarm going off waking them up, they take a quick look around and just sigh before shaking their head in humorous disbelief. We then see the protag going through their morning routine, making coffee etc, they sit at the table looking quite confused about what to do, sitting in the kitchen sipping their coffee they hear a single knock from the bedroom, they look first in fear then say aloud "that's it, this is driving me up the walls". They storm outside and across to the neighbour's house knocking on the front door angrily, no answer. They angrily say "I know someone's home" before continuing to knock on the door. They take a step back frustrated then look at the door handle, we see them have an internal battle about whether they should try the door, they look around to see if anyone would see then step back up to the door. They grab the handle, twist the knob and to their surprise are able to push the door open, they gently swing it open and just stare into the darkness for a moment, the pluck up the courage and take one final look to see if anyone is watching them, and they enter.

They creep along the hallway noticing a house identical to their dream, and then they enter the same bedroom as the dream noticing the same beaten and blackened wall, they audibly say "Oh you are fucking kidding" before backing out into the hallway (the figure is seen in the background) They rush back up the front door which is now locked, they frantically try to open it as we see the creature appear behind them, the protag becomes aware that they are being watched and they quickly turn round to face the threat, the camera pans and nothing is there, it pans back as they face the door again, still nothing is there, they reach to try the door again and we hear fast paced footsteps coming up the hallway, the protag quickly turns round and for a brief moment we see the creature coming towards them with a hand outstretched. We then cut to an outside wide angle of the neighbour's house which pans and moves across to show the protag bringing boxes into their house.

It then quickly cuts to the Protag waking up on the floor in the neighbour's hallway after they were attacked, dazed they take a look around before rising to their feet, they try the door one more time just to see that it's locked, so still dazed the shuffle through the hallway into the bedroom that mirrors their bedroom, they turn to leave the bedroom but hear a knock on the wall that must be coming from their side. They look shocked, angry and scared all at once and slowly approach the wall, they approach and examine it for a moment before reaching a hand out to knock the wall, they are hesitant, but then knock back, it then cuts back to the shot from earlier in the film when the protag turns round with the box after hearing the knock.

The End.

Additional/Alternate Ideas

Man's unpacking in an apartment, something accidentally falls into the wall and creates a knock sound, he lifts it and goes to walk away but then here's a knock from the other side, they knock back and forth until he playfully knocks and nothing comes back, few shots across the course of a week of him doing things in the house, he'll look at that wall with wonder, then one night the knocking starts (something creepy happens) and the next day he goes next door to complain, maybe he knocks the door and it opens up to a dilapidated apartment that's been abandoned for some time, maybe he dies, idk.

The film begins with a zoom up to the door on a small house, after allowing time for the title to show the camera will have zoomed into the door and suddenly a fist appears on screen knocking on the door...

The door is opened by an older man who greets the knocker before saying "everything's ready to go" then handing the key over to the hand and saying "welcome to your new home" the camera then cuts

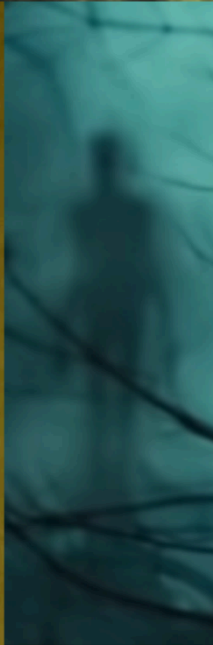
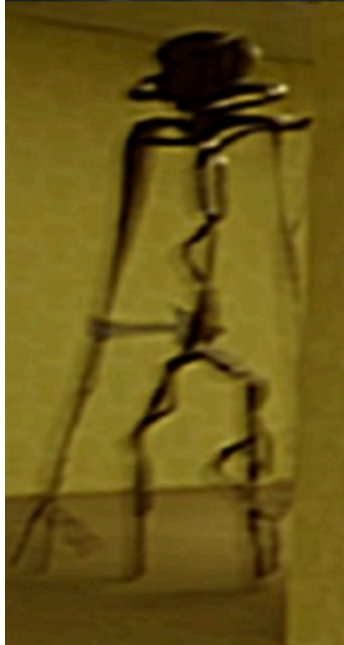
CREATURE IS ONLY IN DREAMS

Creature is protagon?

What if neighbours house is an exact flip of protagon? Easier for filming and possible threat in future film

Maybe add a scene in leaving voice mail to protagonist

<https://www.studiobinder.com/blog/how-to-write-a-screenplay/>



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Character List



Bella

Age: 24

After graduating from university for sports journalism, Bella is moving into her first home, somewhere quiet that she can focus on writing while also being close to where she plays hockey. She is excited about the prospect of moving into her home but loses that sentiment quickly when weird occurrences begin with the house next door. She's quite fearless, not that she isn't terrified of what's going on around her, but that she has a realistic and relatable response to horror and will reluctantly face it instead of hiding.

Appearance:

Moving into her house means she's dressed very casually, spending the majority of the day moving and unpacking boxes, setting up furniture and decorating, with occasional journalistic writing in the evening, her clothes, while stylish, prioritise comfort and simplicity. For this reason, she wears her hair back during the day.



The Creature

Age: ?

About:

Not much is known about the dark silhouetted creature, what began as innocent knocks on Bella's wall turned into a nightmare at the hands of this entity, which seems to endlessly pursue Bella for reasons unknown, is it to hurt her, or is it trying to warn her.

Appearance:

The creature is hard to see especially in the dark, but appears as a tall and slender almost shadow-like figure. On close inspection it looks almost as if it's skin is melting like a burning candle.

Knock Knock

By

Adam J Smyth
ZeusWeusFilm

1 EXT. FRONT GARDEN - DAY

A suburban street, quiet and empty.

A car door closes and BELLA (20 something , student) emerges from the car.

She stares at the bungalow, pleased with herself, then removes a filled cardboard box from the passenger seat of the car, struggling along the footpath towards the bungalow.

2 INT. LIVING ROOM - DAY

Bella collapses on the sofa with a cup of tea. She is accompanied by a couple of cardboard boxes.

She spots a soft toy in one of the boxes.

She lifts the toy from the box, it brings a smile to her face.

BELLA
Well Barney, we made it.

She places Barney beside her on the sofa, then looks at all the boxes.

BELLA
(Sighs) Right, lets get started.

BELLA stands up to stretch accidentally causing a box to topple over and knock into a standing lamp, this lamp then knocks into the wall.

BELLA sets the lamp back up and lifts the box to go unpack when suddenly she hears a knock on the other side of the wall. BELLA turns around and examines the wall with confusion, jokingly she places the box down on the sofa and knocks back, a few seconds pass and she hears one back, amused, BELLA knocks a second time and anticipates a response, but nothing happens. Assuming it was kids she happily shakes her head, picks up the box and continues on.

Montage of moving into the house.

- Bella lifts electrical cables from a box and begins untangling.

- Bella deciding on paint colours, screws up her face as she doesn't like the colour options.

- Bella still struggling with the wires

- Bella painting walls

(CONTINUED)

- Bella still untangling cables, gives up and throws them back in the box.

- the boxes disappearing as she unpacks them.

3 INT. BATHROOM - NIGHT

Bella stands at the sink in pajamas brushing her teeth.

She notices what appears to be dirt on her hands and begins to wash them, she does so for a moment but notices it hasn't come off, she applies more soap and scrubs them harder which has no effect.

Tired and slightly frustrated, she decides to just go to bed.

4 INT. HALLWAY - NIGHT

BELLA makes her way down the hallway towards the bedroom, when she reaches it and peers in to see the bed covered in boxes her demeanour deflates.

BELLA
I am not dealing with that
tonight...

She proceeds to take a pillow and blanket from the hall cupboard and heads into the living room.

5 INT. LIVING ROOM - NIGHT

BELLA is lying on the sofa under her blanket with a pillow and Barney watching a horror film. After a few moments the knocking starts, startling BELLA and causing her to jump up off the sofa. She stares angrily and worryingly at the wall.

BELLA
(Yelling) Give it a rest!

The knocking stops, and silence persists for a moment, BELLA snaps out of her fear and anger, switches off the television, and gets back under her blanket to get to sleep.

6 INT. LIVING ROOM - NIGHT

Faint knocks slowly start to build, gaining in volume and clarity just as BELLA starts to wake and come into focus. BELLA jolts awake to a panic and jumps out of bed staring fearfully at the wall.

BELLA
(Quietly) What the fuck?

The knocking continues, making BELLA even more anxious.

(CONTINUED)

BELLA
(Shouting) What is your problem?

As soon as she shouts, footsteps can be heard rapidly leaving the other side of the wall, BELLA's anger changes to confusions and slight fear as she waits to see if the neighbor has quit, BELLA sighs from fatigue and relief and is about to go back to bed before casually looking across to the window only to see CREATURE staring in at her.

BELLA gasps in shock, and slowly approaches the window with a terrified expression.

Loud footsteps indicate the CREATURE has run from away from the window.

7 INT. HALLWAY - NIGHT

BELLA frantically opens the hall cupboard again, taking out her hockey stick.

Slowly and cautiously she starts to move up the hallway towards the front door, clutching the Hockey Stick.

BELLA unlocks the front door, takes a deep breath and prepares to go out, she bursts out the door quickly as if to startle anything out there.

8 EXT. FRONT GARDEN - NIGHT

BELLA in a mixture of anger and fear, frantically looks round to confront the CREATURE, but the street is empty. Just as she is starting to relax and think it was just her imagination, fast footsteps are heard scuttling around the side of the neighbor's house causing BELLA to jump and snap into defensive mode.

She crosses along the front of the two houses raising her hockey stick when reaching the corner of the neighbor's house, nothing is there, she heads back but stops as she notices the neighbor's front door being open.

With a terrified expression BELLA turns her head to peer into the dark hallway, she takes a minute to build up the courage, raises her stick, and proceeds to enter.

9 INT. NEIGHBOR'S HALLWAY - NIGHT

As BELLA creeps down the hallway she immediately notices how identical the place is to her own house.

She enters the neighbors living room that is opposite to her living room wall.

10 INT. NEIGHBOR'S LIVING ROOM - NIGHT

BELLA notices that the wall opposite to her living room wall that the knocks come from is beaten, blackened and dilapidated.

As BELLA goes to examine the wall, unbeknown to her, the CREATURE is standing in the doorway she just came from, a creek can be heard at the door causing BELLA to quickly glance to her side, nothing is there. She watches the door frame anxiously for a few seconds before turning back to the wall, as soon as she does a face melds through the wall causing BELLA to jump and stumble backwards and fall. As soon as she hits the ground she wakes up on the sofa.

11 INT. LIVING ROOM - NIGHT

Before BELLA has time to comprehend that it was all a dream, the knocks she was hearing in said dream can be heard again as if she had woken up the same way she just had in her dream.

She quickly stands up, the realization can be seen in her face that her life is now mimicking her dream she just awoken from.

BELLA
(Fed up) Oh fuck off...

She looks around for a brief second, grabs her headphones, puts them on, grabs Barney and gets back into bed.

12 EXT. NEIGHBORHOOD - MORNING

The neighborhood is quite, not a person, car or sound in sight.

13 INT. LIVING ROOM - MORNING

BELLA is woken by her phone alarm, sitting up she looks around her to make sure everything is normal, she sighs in humorous disbelief and gets up to start her day.

14 INT. BATHROOM - MORNING

While BELLA is brushing her teeth, her attention is captured by her hands again, the dark, dirt-like substance looks worse than it did before.

Bella, Grossed out. Uses a lot of soap and furiously scrubs at her hands to remove the substance but still to no avail, frustrating BELLA.

15 INT. KITCHEN - MORNING

BELLA, standing at the counter top making a coffee, carries it to the table and calmly begins drinking it, she goes to take another sip when she hears a knock coming from her living room wall, she looks out into the hallway in fear, but that fear quickly turns to a stern expression.

BELLA
That's it, this is driving me up
the walls.

She sets her coffee down and storms up the hallway to the front door.

16 EXT. FRONT GARDEN - MORNING

BELLA exists the house and walks across to the neighbor's front door and starts furiously knocking on it, no answer.

BELLA
(Sternly) I know someone's home!

After knocking for a few seconds more she takes a step back frustrated. She glances around and makes eye contact with the door handle, we see BELLA having an internal debate on whether she should try the door, she looks around to see if anyone would see her then steps up to the door and tries the handle.

To her surprise the door opens, she gently pushes it fully open only to see the dark hallway she had dreamed about, she looks a nervous but takes one last look around her before entering the house.

17 INT. NEIGHBOR'S HALLWAY - MORNING

She creeps along the hallway looking more uneasy the further she travels as she realizes this is exactly how she imagined the house in her dream.

18 INT. NEIGHBOR'S LIVING ROOM - MORNING

She enters the living room that the knocks are coming from and notices the wall is just as blackened and beaten as it was in her dream.

BELLA
(Shocked) Oh you are fucking
kidding

BELLA backs back out into the hallway.

19 INT. NEIGHBOR'S HALLWAY - MORNING

A panicked BELLA rushes back up the hallway towards the front door, the CREATURE is seen further up the hallway unbeknown to her.

However the front door is now locked, BELLA frantically tries to open it as the CREATURE appears at the bottom of the hallway. After a few seconds of trying to open the door BELLA realizes she is being watched, she quickly turns around to face the threat but nothing is there, so she turns back to the door and begins trying to open it again when fast paced footsteps can be heard coming up the hallway.

BELLA quickly turns around and we see the CREATURE coming with it's hand outstretched.

20 EXT. NEIGHBOR'S HOUSE/BELLA'S HOUSE - MORNING

The outside of the neighbor's house is seen, it looks relatively normal, however we move across to BELLA'S house as we see her dressed in her clothes from the previous day, carrying boxes into her house.

21 INT. NEIGHBOR'S HALLWAY - DAY

BELLA wakes up on the floor of the neighbor's hallway, shes dazed and unable to see clearly, her hands and now parts of her face are exhibiting much more of the dark substance from earlier, she looks around confused and scared before rising to her feet. She tries the door one last time but it's still locked, still dazed, she shuffles back down the hallway into the neighbor's living room.

22 INT. NEIGHBOR'S LIVING ROOM - DAY

Seeing that nothing has changed she turns to leave before hearing a knock coming from her side of the wall.

This quickly shocks BELLA out of her dazed state as now she realizes something or someone is in her house, looking shocked, angry and terrified all at once she slowly approaches the wall and examines it for a moment before raising her hand to knock back.

She hesitates, but knocks back.

23 INT. LIVING ROOM - DAY

Exactly like the previous day, we see BELLA carrying a box away from the sofa, but turning when she hears a knock after the lamp falls into the wall, she smiles.

THE END

Location Recce

Location 1: 65 Dunsuivnish Ave Portstewart, Northern Ireland



Perfect layout to allow Bella to easily walk across the investigate the neighbour's house, not to mention, the symmetry of both houses make not only shots much easier to do (just in case access to the neighbour's house is limited or not allowed) but also adds a little bit of credence to the story.

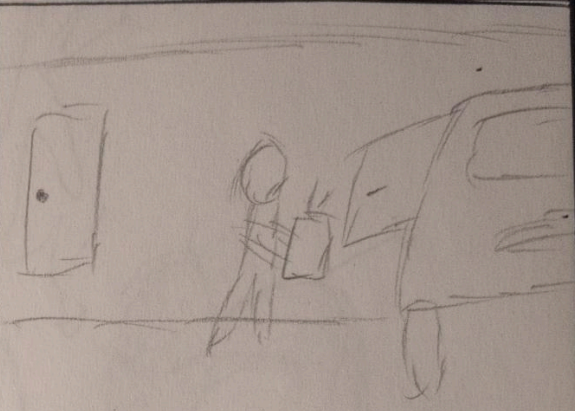
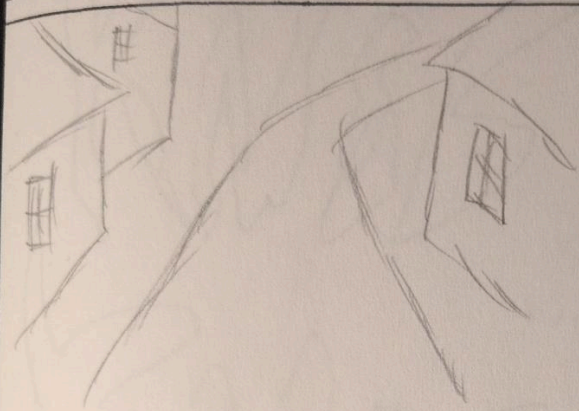
On that note it also helps that the avenue is quite dull and derelict (no offense Michael) which will help to capture much of the desired tone established in the mood board and original story concepts.

The entirety of the film takes place here.



Knock Knock

PG 1



WS- Quiet Neighbourhood

Knock Knock

PG1

WS-Quiet Neighbourhood